

B-Schools: The New face of Leadership – Implications for Management Education

An interview with S. Neelamegham

Dr. S. Neelamegham, a revered Marketing Guru, a doyen in Management Education and a well-known management adviser, and presently the President of NIILM Centre for Management Studies gave an exclusive interview to India Today. The excerpts are reproduced below.

"Running a successful business today is far more complex than ever the twin forces of globalization and technology revolution have orchestrated a whole new wave of changes across economies and societies and radically impacted the way we lead our lives, organizations and businesses", says Prof. S. Neelamegham, President, NIILM Centre for Management Studies.

In this fast changing business landscape, successful companies get differentiated from the average companies not so much by the elegance of their strategic plans as by the capacity of the managers within to move ideas to action to be action-oriented, to be able to build entrepreneurial vision and the ability to lead, adapt and manage change. Says Prof. Neelamegham, "Leadership in a new global economy is much more collaborative, and, therefore, we have to inculcate in our students the need to work as a team, build consensus, cooperation and collaboration rather than conflict and competition in accomplishing the task".

To the question what have been the strategies and approach Prof. Neelamegham adopted to convert NIILM CMS into one of the top business schools in the country, he quipped, NIILM CMS's rapid growth into one of India's best B-schools has only one reason- a dogged customer focus a very unique creative way to interpreting and implementing it. Everything else is just detail which flows smoothly from this vision.

Explaining NIILM's "excellence building" process, Prof. Neelamegham says, "First, we restructured the entire value-chain of the institution and installed a dynamic learning apparatus as its mastermind. This apparatus has consistently helped us commit the right levels of efforts and resources to the task of developing a strong faculty-base apart from innovatively designed curricula and pedagogy; and perhaps most importantly, a very dynamic and intellectually stimulating learning environment. Consequently, all NIILM curricula are revalidated annually, and now we are moving towards making many of them open architecture. We are

following this philosophy because management as a body of knowledge reinvents very rapidly and, therefore, as an institution we have to respond to these changes with a minimum lag to enable executives replenish their knowledge stocks as close to real time as possible" he declares.

A trip to the center amply shows how knowledge creation through research and case generation has been the other critical area for NIILM CMS over the last few years. The Corporate Resource Center of NIILM CMS is dedicated to serve the students and recruiters. It is a high priority, high investment center which organizes several workshops and other events to establish closer relationship with the corporate sector and organizes on-campus interviews with several companies.

The success of the students passing out of NIILM CMS owes a lot as much to their individual efforts as to the kind of assistance they receive in terms of quality education under the effective guidance of faculty body comprising well known academic masters and seasoned practitioners in different subject areas. With such a core faculty base, excellent placement facilities and the state-of-the-art infrastructure made available to the students, NIILM CMS undoubtedly stands today as one of the finest institutions in the country. With global integration on its way NIILM CMS is now planning forays into several frontier areas including global management, CRM service management, retailing and global supply chain management.

